

STAGE FIFTEEN • BUSINESS & ORGANIZATIONAL ACUMEN

FIRSTS

COMPLETION CRITERIA

What counts as done, and how it triggers the Stage Fifteen credential

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

FIRSTS • Completion Criteria & Credential Trigger

Stage Fifteen • Business & Organizational Acumen

PURPOSE

This document defines exactly what “complete” means for Stage Fifteen, at both the individual FIRST level and the full-stage level, and how completion connects to the program's credentialing system. Given this stage's analytical depth, particular weight is placed on FIRST S14 (Business Case Created), the single most complex deliverable in the stage, rather than treating all twenty-five FIRSTS as equally weighted checkboxes.

Per-FIRST Standard

STANDARD

A FIRST counts as complete when the corresponding Templates worksheet has a genuine, specific answer in every required field — not a vague generality where the prompt calls for real analysis (e.g., naming an actual stakeholder or department, not just “various stakeholders”), and for FIRST S23, when a specific, real process improvement has genuinely been proposed, not just identified.

Stage-Level Completion Checklist

- All 25 Templates worksheets completed with genuine, specific answers (see per-FIRST standard above).
- Attendance or async completion confirmed for all 3 sessions.
- A complete business case (FIRST S14) with real or realistic figures, not left substantially blank.
- A genuine, honest full-stage reflection completed for FIRST S25, naming both a real strength and a real gap.

Facilitator Sign-Off

The facilitator reviews each participant's completed Templates workbook, paying particular attention to FIRST S14 (Business Case) given its complexity and central role in this stage. Spot-check for genuine specificity — a stakeholder map listing only “various internal stakeholders” or a business case with placeholder figures should not be marked complete without a request to revisit it.

Credential Trigger

HOW THE BADGE WORKS

Upon facilitator sign-off, the participant's record is marked “Stage Fifteen Complete” in the program tracker, which triggers the Stage Fifteen digital badge. As with every stage, badges accumulate visibly; the full-program certificate is issued only once all 16 stages are marked complete.